

Vintage 2025 Release Notes

The Vintage 2025 population estimates incorporate the following methodological changes developed since the release of the Vintage 2024 estimates. For more details, please refer to the full Vintage 2025 methodology statement: <http://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/popest/technical-documentation/methodology.html>.

Base Population

Vintage 2025 represents a notable departure in the methodology used to create the base population relative to the other vintages produced since 2020. This method change has substantial impacts on the demographic characteristics of the base population data. This is because the April 1, 2020 estimates base is now developed almost entirely from the 2020 Census via the Modified Age and Race Census (MARC) file.

The base population for the new 2025 estimates uses full demographic characteristic detail from the MARC file (age, sex, race, Hispanic origin and group quarters by major type¹). It has also been updated to reflect both the Count Question Resolution (CQR) and Post-Census Group Quarters Review (PCGQR) programs as well as January 1, 2025 geographic boundaries.

The only other data source used to develop the base population is the Vintage 2020 population estimates. Research has indicated an undercount in the population aged 0 to 10 in the 2020 Census nationally, so we incorporate Vintage 2020 age-by-sex totals at the county level for these ages to adjust their April 1, 2020, MARC populations.

For Puerto Rico, the base population uses the MARC file for age and sex (no race or Hispanic origin), with no adjustment.

Vital Statistics

Vintage 2025 represents completion of the phased elimination of using vital statistics data from the Federal-State Cooperative for the Population Estimates (FSCPE). In previous vintages, representatives from the FSCPE contributed data on the geographic distribution of recent vital events within their respective states, but many of the reasons for combining the National Center for Health Statistics (NCHS) and FSCPE data sources are no longer applicable. Mainly, the timeliness and completeness of the NCHS provisional data has surpassed what we are able to collect from the FSCPE. Vintage 2025 fully excludes the FSCPE data and uses only the NCHS data at the national and subnational levels to estimate births and deaths.

An additional update was made to the births component. Each vintage, births are adjusted to resolve inconsistencies between the imputed race and Hispanic origin distributions of births and those distributions in the April 1, 2020 estimates base for the population under age 1. For more details on this adjustment, please refer to the full Vintage 2025 methodology statement. Vintage 2025 will be the first

¹ The seven major group quarters facility types utilized in estimates production are: adult correctional institutions, juvenile institutions, nursing homes, other institutional facilities, college dormitories, military housing, and other noninstitutional facilities. While we do not release estimates of the group quarters population by facility type, these data are used to calculate population universes such as "civilian noninstitutionalized."

this decade to include the MARC file and the 2020 Census race and Hispanic origin detail (see section above). The resulting adjustment for consistency causes shifts—up or down—in the race and Hispanic origin of the births while still maintaining general natality patterns and also prevents a disconnect between the cohorts in the base population and those born after April 1, 2020.

Net Domestic Migration

Due to new disclosure avoidance policies implemented at the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) in April 2025, updated data required to calculate the net domestic migration rates of the population aged 65 and older were not received. As a result, the July 1, 2024 to July 1, 2025 net migration rates for the population aged 65 and older will reflect migration between July 1, 2023, and July 1, 2024.

Estimates of net domestic migration for ages 0 to 64 are typically derived from Internal Revenue Service (IRS) data on tax returns for the first 39 weeks of the year. For 2025, tax return data for the first 26 weeks of 2025 were received, but not the subsequent file covering 13 additional weeks (i.e., the 39-week file). Instead, the 26-week file for 2025 was used in combination with the 39-week file for 2024 to generate domestic migration rates for 2024 to 2025. This is expected to affect only the Vintage 2025 estimates cycle.

Net International Migration

In Vintage 2024, we adjusted the national level of non-U.S.-born immigrants upward for July 1, 2021 to June 30, 2024 to reflect recent increases in humanitarian migration. In Vintage 2025, we improve the geographic distribution applied to that flow of humanitarian migrants by utilizing immigration court records from the Executive Office of Immigration Review (EOIR). We calculate the proportion of cases that correspond to states and counties within states and then apply these proportions to nation and state estimates of the total number of humanitarian migrants. We also make a downward adjustment for a very small selection of counties with implausibly high numbers of EOIR cases.

To assess the increase in emigration reported over the period since July 1, 2024, we evaluated data from U.S. surveys, U.S. agencies (including agencies in our Benchmark Database²), and a Mexican survey, which collectively show higher levels of emigration, including an increase in Mexican-born people and U.S.-born children moving in the past estimate year to Mexico from the United States.

To account for these changes, in Vintage 2025 we use new quarterly data from the National Survey of Occupation and Employment (ENOE in Spanish) conducted by the National Institute of Statistics and Geography (INEGI in Spanish) to adjust the levels of both non-U.S.-born emigration and U.S.-born net migration upwards for July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025.

For non-U.S.-born emigration, we adjusted our July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025 national estimate upward to ENOE levels for the following emigration groups:

- Males born in Mexico who entered the United States within the past 10 years
- Females born in Mexico who entered within the past 10 years

² Details on the Benchmark Database are available at <https://www.census.gov/newsroom/blogs/random-samplings/2024/12/international-migration-population-estimates.html> and <https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/popest/technical-documentation/methodology/2020-2024/methods-statement-v2024.pdf>.

- All persons born in Mexico who entered more than 10 years ago
- All persons born in another country who entered within the past 10 years

For U.S.-born net migration, we increased the July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025 national total upward by adding the ENOE estimate of the total U.S.-born population moving to Mexico in the same period.

Housing Unit Estimates

In Vintage 2024, estimates of loss were based on rates derived from the 2009 and 2011 American Housing Survey (AHS) at the regional level. The Vintage 2025 estimates calculate regional annual loss rates using data from the 2015, 2017, 2019, 2021, and 2023 AHS. Due to changes introduced to the AHS weighting and processing in 2015, loss rates are calculated for three time periods to ensure consistent denominators and then averaged to produce a single set of rates representing annual housing loss by region, type, and age of structure. Those time periods are 2015 to 2019, 2017 to 2021, and 2019 to 2023. Type and age of structure were assigned to the April 1, 2020 housing unit estimates base using distributions calculated from the 2022 American Community Survey (ACS) five-year file, updated from the 2012 ACS five-year file utilized in the previous vintage.

Note: The Census Bureau has reviewed the Vintage 2025 population estimates data products to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data used to produce these products (Data Management System (DMS) number: P-6000042 and P-7501659. Disclosure Review Board (DRB) approval number: CBDRB-FY25-0446).